Blocker Clustering

Log every blocker, cluster them by cause, and fix the cluster that costs the most days.

Manage Flow · Inspired by Klaus Leopold & Troy Magennis · Blocked Time · Root Causes

LEGEND

- Pink Sticky = One blocker
- Yellow Sticky = Cluster name

1 Blocker Log

ONE ROW PER BLOCKER · CAUSE, NOT PERSON

DATE	ITEM	BLOCKED BY (WHAT)	INSIDE / OUTSIDE TEAM	DAYS BLOCKED

2 Blocker Stickies

KEEP THEM AFTER THEY'RE CLEARED

- A pink sticky on the card the moment it's blocked
- Write the cause and the start date
- When it's cleared, add the days and move it here

Cleared blocker stickies

3 Clusters

GROUP SIMILAR CAUSES · NAME EACH CLUSTER

Cluster: _____

Pink stickies

Count: _____ Days: _____

Cluster: _____

Pink stickies

Count: _____ Days: _____

Cluster: _____

Pink stickies

Count: _____ Days: _____

Cluster: _____

Pink stickies

Count: _____ Days: _____

Cluster: _____

Pink stickies

Count: _____ Days: _____

4 Fix the Biggest Cluster

BY TOTAL DAYS BLOCKED, NOT COUNT

Biggest cluster: _____

Root cause: _____

Experiment to fix it: _____

Owner & review date: _____

5 Trend

IS IT WORKING?

PERIOD	BLOCKERS	DAYS BLOCKED

"What keeps blocking us, and what does it cost?"

"Which cluster, if we fixed it, would give us the most days back?"

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